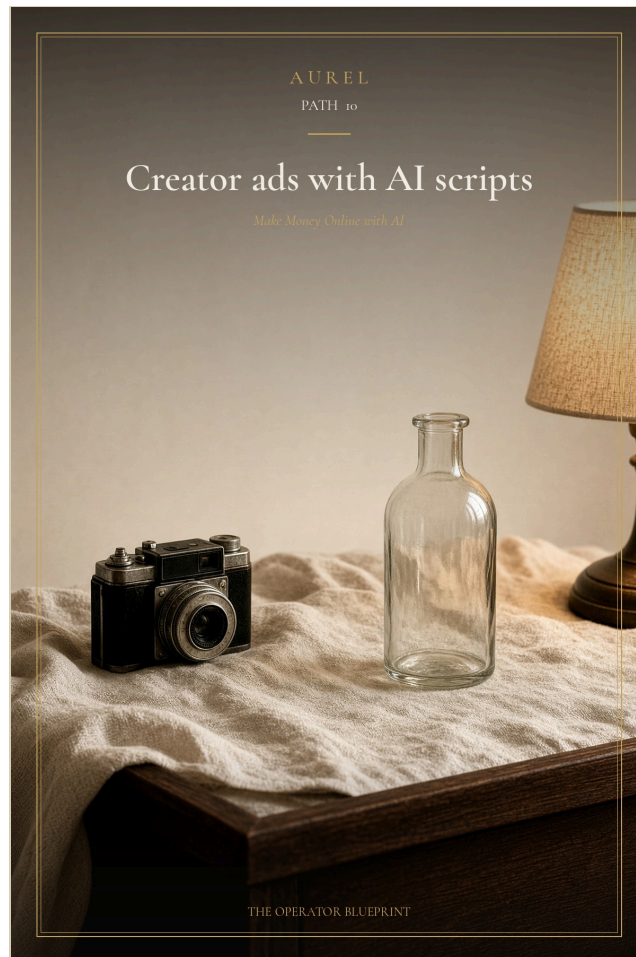




PATH 10

Creator ads with AI scripts

Brands need simple product videos. You do not need to be famous. You need to be clear.

19 minute read · 4,173 words

Who this is for

You are comfortable on camera. You can hold a product and talk.

Time to first

7–21 days

Tools

First sale

One paid brief for two videos.

Cash window

\$150–\$800 for a first two-video pack

Leave this alone

Phone, CapCut, a rate card, AI for script outlines only. Working for exposure. Promising virality.

What you are selling

UGC-style ads are not influencer fame. They are short product videos a brand can run as ads or organic posts. Demo, list, stitch, talking-head. Fifteen to thirty seconds. Vertical. You on camera, product in hand, a sentence a person would actually say in a store aisle.

The buyer is a small brand that cannot hire a studio and does not want another polished TV spot. They want a video that looks like a customer. You are that customer, on purpose, with a script you can say without blinking at a teleprompter.

AI drafts the script outline. You throw away anything you would not say out loud to a friend while chopping onions. If the model writes ‘this revolutionary garlic press will transform your weeknight ritual,’ that line dies. ‘I used to smash garlic with a knife and a prayer. This thing takes four seconds’ stays.

You do not need to be famous. You need to be clear. A sample ad for a product already on your shelf is your portfolio. Two samples beat a nine-page media kit with follower screenshots. Brands who pay \$400 for two videos are not buying your audience. They are buying files they can load into Ads Manager this week.

What this is not

This is not a promise that the ad will go viral. You cannot promise that. Anyone who asks you to guarantee ROAS on day one is asking you to lie or to become their media buyer. You are the creator of the asset. Media buying is a second package, later, if you even want it.

This is not working for exposure, free product, or ‘we will tag you.’ Free product is not a brief. A paid pack is a brief. If you want the product, buy it and film a sample. Then send the invoice path, not the barter path.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you are comfortable on camera. Not ‘love being an influencer.’ Comfortable. You can hold a product, talk for twenty seconds, and not apologize to the lens. A kitchen, a window, a phone is enough. You do not need a ring light army.

It also fits if you already buy in a niche: kitchen tools, skincare you actually use, hardware in the garage, a software login you open every morning. The niche is the drawer you already have. Samples from that drawer are honest. Samples from a niche you are faking will sound like a press release.

Skip this if

Skip it if you hate being on camera and were hoping the model would generate a face. Faceless slideshow ads exist. They are a different product. This path is you, a product, a sentence.

Skip it if you want to wait for a marketplace to send you brands. Those platforms take a cut and train you to bid against people who work for \$50. You will email five brands you already use.

Skip it if you will promise virality to close the deal. Sell the files, the deadline, and one revision. Not a lottery ticket.

The offer, named in one sentence

Write this on the rate card before you film: ‘Two product videos, one revision, seven days, \$400. Vertical files you can run. Samples on this page.’

That is the whole offer. Not a menu of 12 packages. Not a 20-video retainer. Two videos. One pack. A date.

The four parts

Deliverable: two 15–30 second vertical videos (9:16), captions burned in, raw clips optional if you want to upsell later.

Process: they send the product facts and claims they can actually make. You script, shoot, edit. They get one round of notes. You deliver files, not a login to your brain.

Timeline: seven days from product-in-hand (or from the day they ship it to you) to files in a folder.

Price: \$400 for the first two-video pack in kitchen tools. The cash window for a first pack anywhere in this path is \$150–\$800. Start where you can say the number without flinching, then raise.

If you cannot name the niche in the sentence — ‘two kitchen-tool product videos’ — you do not have an offer yet. ‘I make UGC’ is a category. Categories do not get replies.

What done looks like

Done is a paid brief, not a sample sitting in your camera roll. The first sale is one brand saying yes and paying a deposit for two videos.

The done bar for a pack

Two finished vertical files, 15–30 seconds, captions a muted viewer can follow.

A 3-second hook that names the job (‘I stopped mincing garlic with a knife’).

No medical claims, no fake urgency you know is false, no ‘doctors hate this’ garbage the brand cannot defend.

One revision round, written, with a 48-hour window. After that, new work is a new invoice.

Files named like an adult: Brand-Product-A-hook1.mp4, Brand-Product-B-demo.mp4.

Delivered in a folder they own.

Deposit taken before you shoot. Balance on delivery. You are not a bank.

Done for the business, week one, is smaller: two sample ads live on a page with the \$400 pack spelled out, five emails sent. If those five are not sent, you do not have a business. You have homework.

Pricing the two-video pack

Cash window: \$150–\$800 for a first two-video pack. Alex’s kitchen-tool pack sits at \$400. That number is high enough to filter hobby brands who want free content, and low enough that a six-person company can expense it without a board meeting.

How to pick your number

\$150–\$250 if you have zero samples and need a first paid case. Say it is a founder rate for the first two brands, then it becomes \$400. Write the date you will stop discounting.

\$400 is the default once two samples exist. Two videos, one revision, seven days. Rush in 72 hours: add \$150. Extra revision: \$75. Extra video in the same shoot: \$150. Write those three additions on the rate card so they do not become a conversation.

\$600–\$800 when you have three paid brands in the same niche and a folder of ads that ran. Do not jump there on day one. You have no proof yet.

What you never do

You never work for exposure. You never take ‘we will send you the product and a coupon code’ as payment. You never promise a CPM, a ROAS, or a view count. You sell files. If they want you to run the ads too, that is a second package with a second price, and you should not sell it until you have delivered the files once.

Deposit 50% to hold the week. Balance on delivery, before the revision window starts if you want leverage, or after the one revision if you want to be easier to hire. Pick one. Put it on the page.

The first 72 hours

Film two sample ads. Edit. Put them on a simple page with a package: two videos, one revision, a deadline, a price. Send the page to five small brands you already use. Do not wait to be discovered on a marketplace.

Hours 1–8

Pick the niche from your own shelf. Kitchen tools if that is your drawer. Take two products you already own. Write three hook options each. Speak them into a voice memo. Keep the ones you would say in a store. Throw out the ones that sound like a banner ad.

Hours 9–24

Shoot by a window. Phone vertical. Product in frame in the first two seconds. One take that is good enough. Then a second angle: demo the tool actually working. Edit in CapCut: captions, a light crop, 20 seconds, no trending audio you do not have the rights to. Export.

Hours 25–72

A one-page site or a Notion page: two embedded samples, the rate card line, a deposit link, an email. Send five notes to brands you already buy from. ‘I made two kitchen-tool videos as samples. I can do two for [product] in seven days for \$400, one revision. Page: [link].’ That is the 72 hours. No media kit. No waiting.

The path, step by step

Step 1. Rate card before more gear. Starter pack: two videos, one revision, seven days, \$400. Rush fee. Extra revision. Extra video. Put it on one page. If you cannot say the number out loud, the number is wrong or you are not ready to send email.

Step 2. Niche you already buy in. Kitchen tools, software, skincare, hardware. One. Stay there until you have repeat clients. A sample from your own shelf is honest. A sample from a niche you Googled this morning will sound like it.

Step 3. Two sample ads, not a PDF about your ‘media kit.’ Film a demo and a talking-head for products you own. Brands hire from video. They do not hire from a bio.

Step 4. Brief intake. A form, not a 40-minute ‘discovery call’ that becomes free consulting. Product facts. Three claims they can legally make. Claims you will not make. Two example ads they like (not ‘make it viral’). Ship-to address if they are sending the product. Deadline.

Step 5. Script in your mouth. AI outline: hook, problem, demo, proof, ask. Then rewrite until you can say it while walking across the kitchen. Record a voice memo. If you stumble, the line is too long.

Step 6. Shoot. Window light. Phone at eye height. Product in the first two seconds. Do the job on camera — press the garlic, peel the orange, click the software. Talking about the product without showing it is a lecture.

Step 7. Edit. CapCut is enough. Captions. Cut the breath you took before the sentence. End on the product name and the one action ('link in bio' is their problem; your file can end on the product). Keep a 15-second and a 25-second cut if it is easy.

Step 8. Deliver vertical files they can run. 9:16, under 100 MB if you can help it, no watermark, no your-logo end card unless they paid for a brand frame. You are not their media buyer unless that is a second package.

Step 9. One revision window. Written notes, 48 hours, one round. 'Make it pop' is not a note. 'Swap the first line for the one about the dishwasher' is a note. After the window, new invoice.

Step 10. Ask for the next SKU and one referral. While they are happy. 'If the juicer has a sibling product, I can shoot it in the same setup for \$150 extra next week.' Then: 'Who else in kitchen tools should see the samples?'

Step 11. Stay in one niche. The second brand is easier when you can say 'I already shot a press, a peeler, and a juicer.' Crossing into dental ads because someone asked is how you restart from zero.

Step 12. Raise or productize. After three paid packs, \$500. After a folder of work, a monthly 'four videos, first Friday' retainer. Not before you have delivered once without drama.

Worked example: Alex and the \$400 kitchen-tool pack

Alex cooks most nights in a small apartment kitchen. No studio. A window over the sink. A drawer of tools bought over a few years. That drawer is the niche. Alex did not pick kitchen tools because of a trend report. Alex picked them because the garlic press was already there.

The two samples

Sample 1, garlic press: 18 seconds. Hook: ‘I used to mince garlic with a knife and it made the whole board smell for days.’ Demo: clove in, squeeze, peel the leftover skin, rinse. Last line: ‘Four seconds, and the board stays clean.’ No music fight. Captions on.

Sample 2, silicone spatula: 22 seconds. Hook: ‘If your spatula melts on the pan, that is not a personality, that is a bad tool.’ Demo: scramble, scrape, hold it against the edge. Last line: ‘This one does not smell like burnt rubber. I checked.’

Both shot in one evening. Edited the next morning in CapCut. On a one-page site with this line: ‘Two product videos, one revision, seven days. \$400. Samples on this page.’ Deposit link under the sentence.

The five emails

Alex listed five small kitchen brands already in the cupboard — not Amazon house brands, not All-Clad. A citrus juicer company with 12,000 Instagram followers. A board-scraper shop. A mill seller. Two spatula companies. The email was six lines, the page link, and a still from the garlic-press ad. No media kit.

Day 9: the juicer brand replied. They had a new hand juicer. They wanted two ads: one demo, one ‘why I switched from a cheap press.’ They asked if Alex could ‘also run the ads and get us views.’ Alex said no to the media buying, yes to the \$400 pack, 50% deposit. Product arrived on day 12.

The paid brief

Script outline from the model. Alex cut three fake-urgency lines and one claim about ‘clinically proven juice yield’ the brand could not stand behind. Shot on Saturday. Delivered Monday. One revision: they wanted the sink less messy in the background. Alex reshot the last six seconds. Balance paid. Total elapsed from first email to files: 16 days. Time to first paid brief: inside the 7–21 day window.

Alex did not become famous. Two more kitchen brands hired in the next six weeks because the juicer owner forwarded the page. Same pack. Same \$400. Same niche.

Copy you can paste

Rate card line

Two product videos, one revision, seven days. \$400. Samples on this page.

Add-ons, same card

72-hour rush: +\$150

Extra revision round: +\$75

Extra video in the same shoot: +\$150

Raw clips folder: +\$50

Email to a brand you already buy from

Hi [name] — I already use [product]. I make short product videos brands can run as ads. Two samples here: [link]. I can do two videos for [their product] in seven days, one revision, \$400. 50% to hold the week. If the timing is wrong, ignore this.

Page headline

Kitchen-tool product videos. You get files, not a follower pitch.

Brief questions (send as a form)

Product name and the URL

Three facts that are true

Any claim I must not make

Two ads you like (links)

Where to ship the product, or a date I can film what I have

Deadline, if it is not 'seven days from in-hand'

Delivery note

Files are in this folder. Two vertical mp4s, captions on. One revision window, 48 hours, written notes. After that I am glad to do another round as a \$75 add-on.

Week-by-week

Week 1: two samples. Day 1, pick the niche and the two products on your shelf. Day 2, shoot. Day 3, edit and put them on a page with the \$400 pack. Days 4–7, five emails to brands you already buy. Do not build a marketplace profile instead of sending the five.

Week 2: follow-up and a sixth brand if needed. One follow-up, four days later, one line: ‘Looping this to the top in case it got buried. Samples still here: [link].’ If someone says ‘maybe next quarter,’ ask if they have a sibling SKU now. Do not wait.

Week 3: deliver the first paid brief. Deposit, intake, script in your mouth, shoot, edit, files. One revision. Ask for the next SKU and one name. Do not start a skincare sample ‘while you wait.’

Week 4: stay in the niche. Second pack at the same \$400, or founder-rate closed. Write down what broke in the first shoot (audio, messy sink, a claim you had to cut) and make it a checklist. Four videos in your folder is a portfolio. Forty half-finished ideas is not.

The quality bar

Clear beats cinematic. A stable phone, a window, and a sentence you would say in a store will outperform a shaky dolly shot with a script you cannot pronounce.

Picture and sound

Product in the first two seconds. If they have to wait for the brand, they swipe.

Face or hands, plus the tool doing the job. Talking-head with the product off-screen is a podcast.

Audio you can hear on a phone speaker. A \$20 lav or a quiet room. The dishwasher is off.

Captions. Most people watch muted. If the caption is the whole script in three giant lines, it is unreadable. One short line at a time.

Claims

You do not make medical claims. You do not make ‘this will change your life in 7 days’ claims you know are false. You do not invent a statistic. If the brand sends a claim you would not repeat to a friend, you send it back. The ad is their legal problem and your name on camera. Both matter.

Human

If you would not say it in a store aisle, it does not go in the video. AI outlines. You speak. A little mess in a real kitchen is trust. A fake marble island with a product still in the Amazon tape is not.

What to measure

You are selling packs, not views. Measure the business you control.

Emails sent this week. Five is the floor in week 1. Zero emails means zero briefs, no matter how good the garlic press ad is.

Replies and yeses. A 20–40% reply rate on warm brands you already buy from is normal. Cold marketplace bids will be worse. Stay warm until you have cases.

Days from yes to files. Target seven from product-in-hand. If it is 18, your revision process or your shoot block is sloppy.

Revision count. One is the package. Two means your brief missed the claims list. Three means you are training them to use you as an art department.

Repeat rate. The goal is a second SKU from the same brand, not a new niche. One repeat in the first five clients is a real business.

Do not let a brand make your metric ‘how the ad performed.’ You did not buy the traffic. You made the file. If they insist, you can ask them to send you a screenshot later for your page — as a favor, not as a warranty.

Objections you will hear

‘Can you do it for product only?’ No. Working for exposure is the thing to leave alone. You can buy the product and film a sample. That is marketing. Their product in the mail is not a salary.

‘We need this to go viral.’ You cannot promise that. You can promise two clear videos in seven days. If they need a virality clause, they need a different vendor, or they need to run paid ads, which is their job.

‘We already have a UGC platform.’ Good. Those platforms are full of \$50 videos. Your page is two samples in their exact niche and a human email. Some brands still want that. If they do not, next email.

‘Can we hop on a call?’ Maybe a 15-minute walkthrough after the deposit. A 40-minute ‘let us explore’ call before money is the job. Send the brief form first.

‘Our last creator made medical claims and we got flagged.’ Put the claims-you-will-not-make box on the intake. Write it: ‘I will not say anything you cannot stand behind.’

‘\$400 seems high for two TikToks.’ They are not TikToks. They are product videos a brand can run. Two samples are on the page. If \$400 is wrong for them, \$150 for exposure is wrong for you.

What this path feeds next

A finished pack is a case. Cases feed a \$19 playbook and a skill pack of the outlines you actually used. Do not sell those until you have delivered paid work.

The same niche becomes a retainer: four videos a month, first Friday, one price. Local brands in your town who sell kitchen tools will hire you faster than a national name. Walk in with the two samples on your phone.

What this does not feed: a personal brand built on promising you can make anything viral. Keep the page boring and specific. Kitchen-tool product videos. Files in seven days.

Mistakes that kill this path

Medical claims. Fake urgency you know is false. ‘Clinically proven’ on a garlic press. You will get a brand flagged and you will not get the second SKU.

Unlimited rounds. One revision is a package. Open-ended ‘until we love it’ is a second job you forgot to price.

Waiting for a platform to send you brands. Marketplaces train you to race to \$75. Five emails to brands you already use is the channel.

Working for exposure. Free product is not a brief. A tag is not a deposit.

Reading the AI script like a hostage. If you cannot say it in the kitchen, it does not go in the ad.

Promising virality. You do not control distribution. Sell the files.

Building a 12-item menu before two samples exist. Two videos, one price, one niche. Then a rate card add-on. Then a retainer. In that order.

Tools

Phone. Vertical. Clean the lens. 4K if it will still export a reasonable file; 1080p is fine for ads. You do not need a cinema camera for a spatula.

CapCut. Captions, cuts, export. Stay off music you cannot license. Silence plus the room plus your voice is legal and human.

A rate card. One page. Pack, rush, extra revision, extra video. Not a Figma palace.

AI for script outlines only. Hook, demo beats, a list of claims to avoid. Then your mouth. Then the throw-away pass.

A simple page. Carrd, Notion, Stan, a Google Doc with two unlisted YouTube or Vimeo embeds. Deposit via Stripe. Email you actually check.

A cheap lav or a quiet room. Optional tripod. Window. That is the studio.

Leave the marketplace apps alone until five organic emails have had a chance. Leave the ring-light shopping cart alone until a brand has paid.

Checklist

- Niche picked from a drawer you already have
- Two sample ads shot and edited, 15–30 seconds, captions on
- Rate card: two videos, one revision, seven days, \$400
- Rush, extra revision, extra video written as add-ons
- One-page with samples, price, deposit link
- Brief form: facts, claims you will not make, examples they like
- Five emails to brands you already buy
- One follow-up four days later
- Deposit before you shoot
- Script said out loud, AI lines you would not say are gone
- Vertical files delivered, named, no watermark
- One revision window, 48 hours, written notes
- Ask for the next SKU and one referral
- No virality promise anywhere on the page

FAQ

Do I need followers?

No. Brands paying \$400 for two videos are buying files they can run. Followers are a bonus if you have them. They are not the product. Two samples in the niche beat 40,000 followers in a different niche.

Should I join a UGC marketplace?

You can later. Do not wait on one. Those platforms are useful when you already have a pack and a rate. They are a trap when they are your only channel and the bids start at \$50. Five emails first.

Who pays for the product?

For samples, you do. You already own it. For a paid brief, they ship it or you invoice a product budget. Do not buy \$200 of inventory on a maybe. Deposit first, then shipping.

How long should each video be?

15–30 seconds for v1. Some ad placements want 6 seconds later. You can cut a 6-second hook from a 20-second file if you shot a clean first line. Do not deliver a 90-second story and call it an ad.

What if I freeze on camera?

Talk to the product, not the lens, for the first sample. Demo-heavy videos hide a shy face. You still need to be willing to be seen. If you cannot, this is the wrong path.

Can I use AI to generate the spokesperson?

Not for this path. Brands hiring UGC want a person. AI is for outlines. You are the mouth.

What about music?

Skip it unless the brand sends a track they own. Trending audio can get an ad pulled. Voice, captions, the sound of the tool — enough.

Do I need an LLC and a contract?

A one-page agreement is enough for pack one: deliverable, timeline, price, revision, claims, who owns the files (they do, on payment). Deposit via Stripe. The agreement cannot wait.

How do I handle a brand that wants 10 videos this week?

That is a different package. Quote it: 10 videos, two revision rounds, 14 days, \$1,600, 50% deposit. Do not say yes at \$400. Do not say yes at all if you cannot shoot that volume without wrecking the seven-day promise to someone else.

What if the first five emails go nowhere?

Send five more in the same niche. Change the subject line to the product you already use. Check that the page loads on a phone. Do not switch to skincare on day eight. The niche is the asset. The emails are the work.